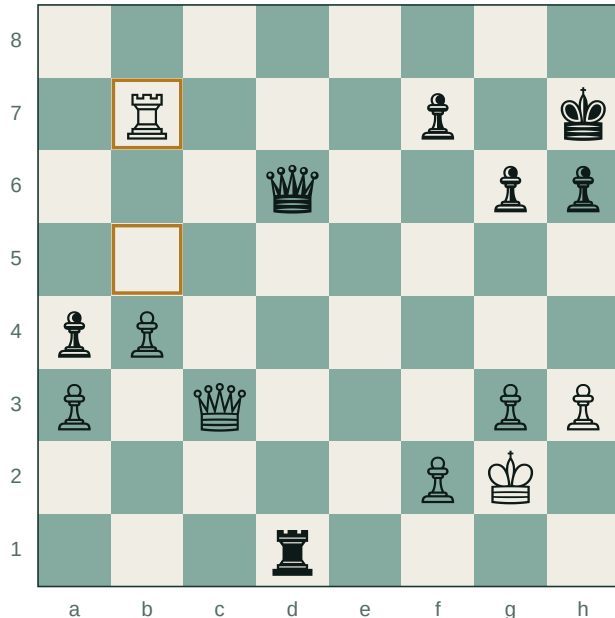


Deflection tactics: Black, move 37

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 37.Rb7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37...Qd5+ 38. Qf3 Rg1+ 39. Kxg1 Qxf3

37...Qd5+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From d5 it attacks king on g2 and rook on b7. Recorded reply: **38.Qf3**.

38...Rg1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **39.Kxg1**.

39...Qxf3 The queen captures the queen on f3.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4**: the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g2. Geometrically undefended: rook on b7 and queen on c3. Check for tactical protection.